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On Air · Sunny

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## 이번 호 기사

|    |     |                                                |   |
|----|-----|------------------------------------------------|---|
| 01 | 기술  | Cities Try Buses That Drive Themselves         | 2 |
| 02 | 환경  | Fast Fashion Is Making Clothes Wear Out Faster | 3 |
| 03 | 스포츠 | Sports Events Leave a Big Carbon Footprint     | 4 |
| 04 | 교육  | What Do We Lose Without Handwriting?           | 5 |
| 05 | 문화  | Libraries Lend More Than Just Books            | 6 |
| 06 | 사회  | Empty Houses and Disappearing Villages         | 7 |
| 07 | 기술  | How Far Should Facial Recognition Go?          | 8 |
| 08 | 환경  | Where Does Your School Lunch Leftovers Go?     | 9 |



# Cities Try Buses That Drive Themselves

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 160 words · L2



자율주행 버스가 다니는 도시

Some cities around the world are now testing buses that drive without a human driver. These buses use cameras, sensors, and computer programs to read the road and move safely. They are called autonomous, or self-driving, buses.

Self-driving buses have been tested in places like Finland, Singapore, and South Korea. They follow set routes and stop at regular bus stops, just like normal buses. However, a safety officer usually sits inside in case something goes wrong.

The buses can detect other vehicles, cyclists, and people on the road. Because they use data from many sensors at once, they can react quickly to sudden changes. Some tests have shown that these buses keep a very steady speed, which can reduce accidents.

Supporting groups say self-driving buses could help elderly or disabled people travel more easily. Cities also hope the technology will cut traffic and lower pollution over time. Experts believe that in a few years, more cities will join the trials.

## 한글 요약

세계 여러 도시에서 카메라와 센서를 활용한 자율주행 버스를 시험 운영하고 있으며, 핀란드, 싱가포르, 한국 등이 대표적인 사례다. 자율주행 버스는 도로 위 장애물을 빠르게 감지하고 일정한 속도를 유지해 사고를 줄이는 데 도움이 될 수 있다. 전문가들은 이 기술이 노인과 장애인의 이동을 돕고 교통 혼잡과 오염을 줄이는 데 기여할 것으로 기대하고 있다.

## WORDS & MEANINGS

**autonomous** 자율적인, 스스로 움직이는  
**sensor** 센서, 감지 장치  
**detect** 감지하다, 발견하다

**route** 노선, 경로  
**trial** 시험, 실험  
**steady** 일정한, 꾸준한  
**disabled** 장애가 있는



# Fast Fashion Is Making Clothes Wear Out Faster

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 129 words · L1



패스트 패션과 옷의 짧은 수명

Clothes are wearing out faster than ever before. Many shops now sell very cheap clothes that are made quickly and in huge amounts. This is called fast fashion.

Fast fashion companies release new styles almost every week. Because prices are so low, people buy more clothes than they need. They often throw them away after wearing them just a few times.

All this thrown-away clothing creates a big waste problem. Millions of tonnes of old clothes end up in landfills every year. Some experts say fast fashion is one of the most harmful industries for the environment.

Many people are now trying to buy less and choose better-quality clothes that last longer. Buying second-hand clothes is also growing in popularity. Small choices like these can help reduce clothing waste.

## 한글 요약

패스트 패션은 저렴한 옷을 대량으로 빠르게 생산하고 판매하는 방식으로, 사람들이 옷을 쉽게 사고 버리는 문화를 만들었다. 매년 수백만 톤의 옷이 매립지에 버려지며, 전문가들은 패스트 패션을 환경에 가장 해로운 산업 중 하나로 꼽는다. 이에 따라 오래 입을 수 있는 옷을 구매하거나 중고 옷을 이용하는 등 의류 폐기물을 줄이려는 노력이 늘어나고 있다.

## WORDS & MEANINGS

**fashion** 패션, 유행

**cheap** 저렴한, 싼

**release** 출시하다, 내놓다

**industry** 산업

**harmful** 해로운

**landfill** 매립지, 쓰레기 매립지

**second-hand** 중고의

**reduce** 줄이다



# Sports Events Leave a Big Carbon Footprint

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 224 words · L3



경기장을 채우는 탄소 발자국

Every time fans fill a stadium to watch their favorite team, something invisible is happening alongside the game. Huge amounts of carbon dioxide are being released into the air, and most people never think about it.

## ## The Hidden Cost of Big Games

Large sporting events use enormous amounts of energy to power lights, screens, heating, and cooling systems. On top of that, hundreds of thousands of fans travel to events by car or plane. This adds even more pollution to the atmosphere.

Some researchers say that a single major sports event can release surprisingly large amounts of carbon dioxide. Over a multi-week event like the Olympics, the total emissions can reach truly enormous levels. These numbers are difficult to

imagine, but scientists agree the impact is significant.

## ## Greener Stadiums Are Fighting Back

Many stadiums around the world are now trying to reduce their environmental impact. Some have installed solar panels and wind turbines to generate clean energy. Others use energy-efficient lighting to cut electricity use.

Recycling programs and smarter water systems are also becoming more common at sports venues. These changes show that big events do not have to be bad for the planet.

Some fans are even choosing public transport or shared rides to lower their own carbon footprint. Small changes from many people can add up to a big difference.

### 한글 요약

대규모 스포츠 행사는 경기장 운영과 팬들의 이동 과정에서 막대한 양의 이산화탄소를 배출하며 환경에 큰 영향을 미친다. 이를 줄이기 위해 많은 경기장들이 태양광 패널 설치, 에너지 효율 조명, 재활용 프로그램 등 친환경 방식을 도입하고 있다. 팬들도 대중교통이나 카풀을 이용하는 등 작은 실천으로 탄소 발자국을 줄이는 데 동참할 수 있다.

Source · ncbi.nlm.nih.gov, nationalgeographic.com

### WORDS & MEANINGS

**carbon dioxide** 이산화탄소  
**atmosphere** 대기, 분위기  
**emissions** 배출물, 배기가스  
**efficient** 효율적인

**venue** 장소, 행사장  
**footprint** 발자국; 환경에 미치는 영향  
**generate** 생산하다, 만들어 내다



# What Do We Lose Without Handwriting?

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 135 words · L1



손글씨를 쓰지 않으면 무엇을 잃을까

Many students today type on keyboards instead of writing by hand. But researchers say that when we stop writing by hand, we may lose some important skills.

Handwriting is not just about putting words on paper. Studies show that writing by hand helps the brain remember information better. When students write notes by hand, they understand and recall the material more easily than when they type.

Scientists believe this happens because handwriting uses more parts of the brain at once. It also helps children learn to read and spell more quickly. Some schools have started to bring back handwriting lessons because of these findings.

Experts say handwriting is still a valuable skill, even in the digital age. Many teachers now encourage students to write by hand, especially when studying for tests or learning something new.

## 한글 요약

연구에 따르면 손으로 글을 쓰면 뇌의 여러 부분이 동시에 활성화되어 정보를 더 잘 기억하고 이해하는 데 도움이 된다. 타이핑이 일상화된 시대에도 손 글씨는 읽기와 철자법 학습에 효과적인 것으로 밝혀졌다. 이 때문에 일부 학교들은 손 글씨 수업을 다시 도입하고 있으며, 전문가들도 손으로 필기하는 습관을 적극 권장하고 있다.

## WORDS & MEANINGS

**researcher** 연구자

**recall** 기억해내다

**material** 자료, 내용

**spelling** 철자 쓰기

**valuable** 소중한, 가치 있는

**encourage** 격려하다, 권장하다

**digital** 디지털의

# Libraries Lend More Than Just Books

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 156 words · L2



도서관이 책 말고 빌려주는 것들

Most people visit a library to borrow books, but libraries today offer much more than that. In many countries, you can borrow tools, fishing rods, baking pans, and even cameras from your local library.

Libraries have always tried to give communities what they need. In the past, that meant lending books and magazines. Now, as people's needs have changed, libraries have expanded their collections to include everyday items that can be expensive to buy.

This kind of lending makes a real difference for many families. If you only need a tool once or twice, borrowing it is much cheaper than buying it. Libraries help people save money while still getting things done.

Some libraries also offer digital services, such as e-books and online music. Because libraries keep finding new ways to help, they remain important places in their communities. It is worth visiting your local library to see what surprising things it might have on offer.

## 한글 요약

오늘날 도서관은 책뿐만 아니라 공구, 카메라 등 다양한 생활용품도 대출해 준다. 이러한 서비스는 비싼 물건을 굳이 구입하지 않아도 되므로 많은 가정에 경제적인 도움이 된다. 도서관은 전자책 등 디지털 서비스까지 제공하며 지역 사회에서 점점 더 중요한 역할을 하고 있다.

## WORDS & MEANINGS

**borrow** 빌리다

**tool** 도구, 공구

**community** 지역 사회

**collection** 소장품, 컬렉션

**expand** 확장하다, 늘리다

**digital** 디지털의

**expensive** 비싼



# Empty Houses and Disappearing Villages

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 226 words · L3



지역 소멸과 늘어나는 빈집

In many parts of Japan and other countries, small towns and villages are slowly getting smaller. Fewer people are being born, and many young people are moving to big cities to find work and better opportunities.

## ## Why Villages Are Disappearing

When people leave a rural area, the remaining population becomes older and smaller. Over time, there are not enough people to keep schools, shops, and local services running. Slowly, the whole community can fade away.

## ## A Growing Problem: Empty Houses

As people move out, they often leave their homes behind. These empty houses can number in the thousands across a country. They slowly fall into

poor condition because no one is there to look after them.

Researchers in Japan have studied how this pattern could spread across many regions if the trend continues. In Finland, similar studies have found that rural areas are losing residents. Property values in these places are also falling.

Some local governments are trying new ways to bring people back. In some countries, programs have been created to connect empty houses with people who want to live in the countryside. These efforts aim to give both the houses and the communities a new start.

Researchers warn that once a village loses all its residents, recovery becomes very difficult. Finding solutions before that happens remains an important challenge for many countries.

### 한글 요약

일본과 핀란드 등 여러 나라에서 젊은 인구가 대도시로 이동하면서 농촌 마을이 점점 사라지고 있다. 사람들이 떠난 자리에는 수천 채의 빈집이 남겨지고, 부동산 가치도 하락하는 등 지역 사회가 무너지고 있다. 일부 지방 정부는 빈집과 귀촌 희망자를 연결하는 프로그램 등을 통해 해결책을 찾고 있지만, 연구자들은 마을이 완전히 비기 전에 대책을 마련하는 것이 중요하다고 강조한다.

Source · [arxiv.org](#), [ncbi.nlm.nih.gov](#)

### WORDS & MEANINGS

**rural** 시골의, 농촌의

**resident** 주민, 거주자

**community** 지역 사회, 공동체

**property** 부동산, 건물

**trend** 추세, 경향

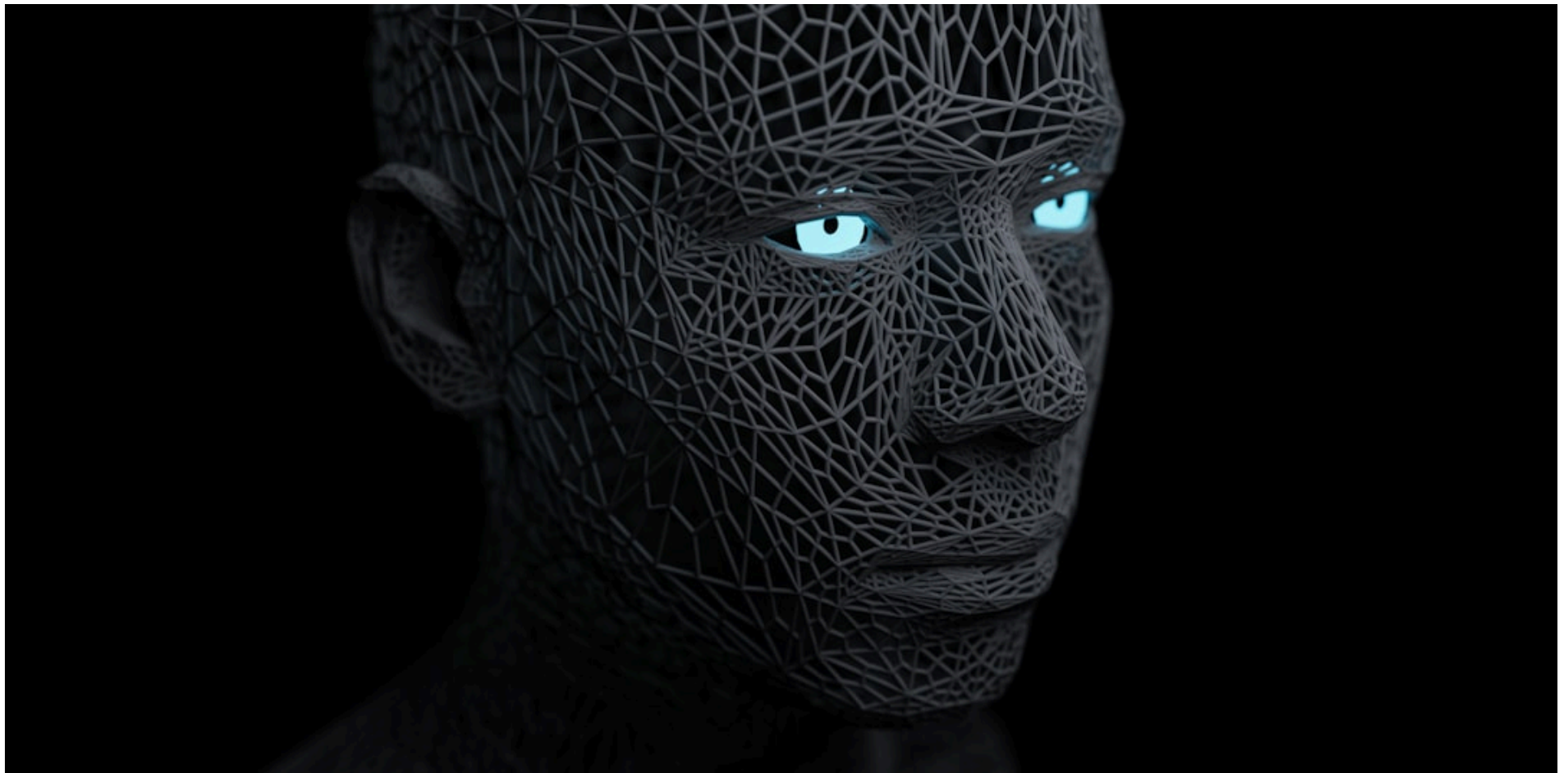
**urgent** 긴급한, 시급한

**fade** 사라지다, 희미해지다



# How Far Should Facial Recognition Go?

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 169 words · L2



얼굴 인식 기술은 어디까지 허용될까

Facial recognition technology can scan a person's face and match it to a database of photos in seconds. Police and airports already use it to find missing people or check identities. But many people are asking how far this technology should be allowed to go.

The technology works by mapping the points on a person's face, like the distance between the eyes or the shape of the nose. A computer then compares this map to stored images. It can work even in a busy crowd, which makes it very powerful.

However, many people are worried about privacy. They feel it is wrong for cameras to scan everyone's face without permission. Some cities, including San Francisco in the US, have banned government use of the technology because of these concerns.

Different countries are now making rules about when and how facial recognition can be used. The goal is to keep people safe while also protecting their rights. Getting that balance right is one of the biggest challenges in technology today.

## 한글 요약

안면 인식 기술은 얼굴을 스캔해 데이터베이스와 대조하는 방식으로 작동하며, 경찰과 공항 등에서 이미 활용되고 있다. 그러나 동의 없이 얼굴을 스캔한다는 점에서 프라이버시 침해 우려가 커지고 있으며, 일부 도시에서는 정부의 사용을 아예 금지했다. 각국은 안전과 개인의 권리를 모두 지킬 수 있도록 안면 인식 기술 사용에 관한 규정을 마련하는 중이다.

Source · ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

## WORDS & MEANINGS

**recognition** 인식, 알아봄

**database** 데이터베이스, 정보 저장소

**identity** 신원, 정체성

**permission** 허락, 허가

**privacy** 사생활, 개인 정보

**balance** 균형

**ban** 금지하다



# Where Does Your School Lunch Leftovers Go?

By Sunny · 2026-08-10 · 227 words · L3



학교 급식 잔반은 어디로 갈까

Every day, students around the world leave food behind on their lunch trays. All of that leftover food has to go somewhere, and the journey it takes is quite surprising.

## A Big Waste Problem

Schools produce a large amount of food waste every single day. Studies in the United States found that students throw away a significant portion of their meals, including fruits, vegetables, and milk. When food ends up in landfills, it releases a harmful gas called methane, which makes climate change worse.

## Where the Food Goes

Some schools send leftover food to programs that collect and deliver it to people who need it. This is called food recovery, and it helps both the

environment and the community. Other schools use food waste to make compost, a natural material that helps plants grow in soil.

There is also a technology called an anaerobic digester. It breaks down food waste without oxygen and produces energy in the process. Some schools and cities are starting to use these machines to turn waste into electricity.

Many schools are also trying to reduce waste before it happens. Share tables let students leave unopened food for others to take. They have helped cut down on the amount of food that gets thrown away.

Knowing where lunch leftovers go can help students think more carefully about what they take and leave behind.

### 한글 요약

학교에서는 매일 많은 양의 음식물 쓰레기가 발생하며, 이는 매립지에서 메탄 가스를 방출해 기후 변화를 악화시킨다. 남은 음식은 음식 회수 프로그램이나 퇴비 제조, 혐기성 소화조를 통한 에너지 생산 등 다양한 방식으로 활용되고 있다. 또한 공유 테이블과 같은 방법으로 애초에 음식물 쓰레기를 줄이려는 노력도 학교 현장에서 이루어지고 있다.

### WORDS & MEANINGS

|                 |         |                 |            |
|-----------------|---------|-----------------|------------|
| <b>leftover</b> | 남은 (음식) | <b>recovery</b> | 회수, 수거     |
| <b>landfill</b> | 매립지     | <b>digester</b> | 분해기        |
| <b>methane</b>  | 메탄 (가스) | <b>reduce</b>   | 줄이다        |
| <b>compost</b>  | 퇴비      | <b>release</b>  | 방출하다, 내보내다 |



